

Breakout Box Kit

WHAT'S IN THE KIT

- 6 breakout boxes, each with: small lock box, 4-digit lock, 3-digit lock, 2 letter/direction locks, key lock, lock hasp
- Hint cards
- Blacklight pens + flashlights
- Reflection cards



QUICK-START GUIDE

1. Pick or design a game: puzzles whose answers open each lock.
2. Free pre-made games at breakoutedu.com or build your own around unit content.
3. Set up boxes identically; teams race to open them.
4. Use hint cards to keep stuck teams moving.
5. Debrief with the reflection cards — the teamwork talk matters most.

FULL LESSONS IN THIS GUIDE

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PRO TIP: Six identical boxes = six competing teams. Build one game, run it all day.

Breakout Box Kit

LESSON · GRADES 3-5

Storybook Escape

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will reread a text closely to extract specific evidence
- Students will collaborate under time pressure
- Students will persist through productive struggle

MATERIALS

- Breakout boxes (6 identical setups)
- Read-aloud text with planted clue connections
- Puzzle cards keyed to comprehension questions
- Hint cards (2 per team) and a visible timer

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Prep: set all six boxes with identical lock combinations tied to text answers.
2. Read the story aloud; warn nobody that details will matter (or do — both work).
3. Reveal the boxes: answers hide in the text; combinations come from evidence.
4. Teams reread, debate, and test combinations — hint cards cost points.
5. First opened box shares the class reward, but every team finishes.
6. Debrief: which clues did you miss on first read, and why?

ACTIVITY

Storybook Escape — comprehension questions become lock combinations, and rereading for evidence becomes urgent. Every team finishes; the debrief on missed clues is the instructional gold.

Breakout Box Kit

LESSON · GRADES 6-8

Unit Review Breakout

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will apply unit content to solve multi-step problems
- Students will decompose complex puzzles into solvable parts
- Students will evaluate teamwork effectiveness honestly

MATERIALS

- Breakout boxes (6 stations)
- Puzzle set built from current unit content (math problems, vocabulary, dates)
- Blacklight pens/flashlights for hidden-clue layers
- Reflection cards (included in kit)

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Build the game: 4-5 puzzles from unit review content, each yielding a lock combination.
2. Layer one blacklight secret — hidden ink on an innocent-looking handout.
3. Brief teams on the scenario and the timer; hints cost time.
4. Run the breakout; observe teamwork patterns without rescuing.
5. Winners open the box; all teams complete a solutions walkthrough.
6. Reflection cards: honest team debrief on communication, roles, and stuck points.

ACTIVITY

Unit Review Breakout — the review sheet, weaponized into locks and blacklight secrets. The teamwork reflection afterward often matters more than the content review.

Breakout Box Kit

LESSON · GRADES 9-12

Student-Designed Escapes

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will design puzzles with calibrated difficulty and clue flow
- Students will playtest and revise an experience from user data
- Students will demonstrate content mastery through design

MATERIALS

- Breakout boxes for both design and deployment
- Game design template: narrative, puzzle map, solution key
- Playtest observation sheet
- A recipient class (younger or parallel) to play the finished games

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Flip the room: teams become designers building games for a real audience.
2. Design constraints: 4+ puzzles, one hidden layer, solvable in 30 minutes, tied to real content.
3. Puzzle map review: trace the solve path for dead ends and ambiguity before building.
4. Internal playtest: another design team runs it while designers observe silently.
5. Revise from observation data: where did testers stall for the wrong reasons?
6. Deploy to the recipient class; designers facilitate and gather reactions.

ACTIVITY

Student-Designed Escapes — designing a fair, solvable game demands deeper mastery than solving one. Silent playtest observation teaches the hardest design lesson: your obvious isn't theirs.